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Reply-to: "Steve Roussos" <tsai_roussos@mindspring.com>

From: "Steve Roussos" <steve@felixburdine.com> | [Block address](#) | [Add to Address Book](#)

To: "Gena Schoen" <confuschoen@yahoo.com>, "Aimee Sherman" <aimeeconplan@hotmail.com>, "Dan Bassill" <tutormentor2@earthlink.net>

Subject: Board Development Workshop Presenter?

Date: Mon, 12 Feb 2001 14:44:54 -0500

Hi all,

I saw this in the OHATS and was wondering if you had heard word from or think these folks would still like to present at the conference?

- Steve

11/21/00; Recorder Name: Gena Schoen

Vikki R. from the National Mentoring Center contacted us to learn more about our conferences, in particular, our conference scheduled for this April/May. They planned to host a regional conference in the Chicago area in April. I provided information about the format/topics of our conference and invited her organization to partner with us. She is going to discuss options with her staff, such as hosting it elsewhere or working with us. She said they could provide a workshop presenter for us at no charge. Possible someone to discuss board development. This was important because it was a step toward building a stronger relationship with the National Mentoring Center. Dan has spoken at their conference in Portland and has tried to build a relationship in the past.

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Subject: Re: T/MC Conference Workshops

Date: Mon, 21 Aug 2000 03:16:22 -0500

From: Paul Collins <pcollins@jordan-webb.net>

Organization: Jordan-Webb

To: "Bassill, Dan" <tutormentor2@earthlink.net>, "Bassill, Dan" <tutormentor1@earthlink.net>, "ROUSSOS, SERGIOS TSAI" <TSAI_ROUSSOS@mindspring.com>

References: 1

Steve:

Please see below for the URL that gets you directly to the TM/C Knowledge Center Website. Take look at my writeup below and let's see how we meld the two. Am I being too ambitious or can we actually do what I propose. What do you think? I think action planning would be pre-mature, but scenario planning might help participants think about and prepare for planning and implementation in their own programs.

Title: TM/C Knowledge Center Surveys - Analysis, Review and Scenario Planning

Presenters: Paul Collins and Sergios Tsai Roussos

Since May of 1999, we have been collecting information about tutor/mentor programs by administering computer-based surveys at the TM/C Conferences and on the TM/C Knowledge Center Website (<http://www.jordan-webb.net/tmc>). The questions are grouped into two distinct surveys, the first one focusing on background information and demographics about programs and the second one focusing on how programs actually operate in their respective communities.

The participants in this workshop will review the survey results and look for themes that represent what is needed to implement and improve programs. The group will also highlight unexpected or surprising results in the data. The facilitators will then help the participants organize into special interest groups that will develop planning scenarios around selected themes. These scenarios will serve as models of and planning guides for possible actions, interactions and reactions that could be expected as these strategies from these themes are applied to programs in the real world.

The cumulative results from these surveys represent the shared wealth of knowledge from many tutor and mentor programs and are viewable and downloadable from the Knowledge Center Website. If you have not taken the opportunity to complete these surveys or view and obtain the results, please go to the TM/C Knowledge Center Website (<http://www.jordan-webb.net/tmc>) and do it now. Even if you are unable to attend the conference or do not plan to attend this workshop, your contribution is needed to this collaborative effort.

Sincerely,

Paul E Collins

Jordan-Webb \ 2656 W Montrose Ave \ Suite 110 \ Chicago, IL
60618-1559

Helping Organizations Deploy: Group Facilitation
Team Collaboration
Support for Distributed/Virtual Teams
Facilitation with Technology
Collaboration with Technology
Electronic Meeting Support
Facilitator Mentoring/Coaching

Related Websites:

Jordan-Webb: <http://www.jordan-webb.net>
GroupSystems: <http://www.GroupSystems.com>
Midwest Facilitators' Network: <http://www.midwest-facilitators.net>
Ethnic Dance Chicago: <http://www.ethnicdance.net>
Door County Folk Festival: <http://www.dcff.net>
QDI Strategies: <http://www.qdistrategies.com>
Paul Collins: <http://my.vovager.net/pcollins>
Midwest Society of Professional Consultants: <http://www.msps.org>
Tutor/Mentor Connection Knowledge Center: <http://www.jordan-webb.net/tmc>

Loyola University CIMT: <http://www.qsb.luc.edu/centers/cimt>

Subject: Re: Allentown update

Date: Sun, 20 Aug 2000 23:12:02 -0700

From: "STERGIOS TSAIROUSSOS" <TSAI.ROUSSOS@mindspring.com>

To: "Daniel Bassill" <tutormentor2@earthlink.net>, "Daniel F. Bassill" <tutormentor1@earthlink.net>

References: 1, 2

Hi Dan,

Sorry to hear the news about Jackie. But it is better that you found this out before too much more time was invested by you or her. I am glad to hear she is staying with KC though, and this is a good opportunity to find a better fit. I agree that one of the bonus qualifications if not a requirement for this position should be experience with using the basic word processor software, excel, email and basic internet skills with enough competence that they could use these skills in their interactions with students and volunteers.

Today, I signed us up with Burlee and the domain name tutormentorexchange.net (\$15/month, \$25 set up fee and I think it's \$70 to register the domain name for 2 years). It will take them 2 or 3 days to set us up completely and then we can start using the site.

I spoke with Paul on Friday. We decided to do 2 workshops and you and Aimee should get the descriptions sometime early this week (I'll prompt Paul again if needed). One workshop will be in place of the one I was to do alone on our web eval system; now that workshop will show all the T/MC eval tools: our web-based system based on the Kansas model, the participation tracking tools, and the jordan-web surveys. We will need a room that we can set up some computers for this. Paul said he can also set up some other computers in an area with more traffic so others can still complete the surveys whenever they wish (but we'll need someone to monitor them while we're in the workshops). The other workshop will be used to show the results from the group systems survey collected to date and use that as a discussion of what the results mean and how to use them for program improvement and tutor/mentor community improvement.

I think we could use your help to make sure we place these workshop in the correct time slots given the times for the other 2 evaluation workshops I'm doing. If needed I may need to cut one of those (I'll go with your recommendation).

Dan, for the Pew grant, your observations are correct. But, if you do know of someone at the Tribune that you can recommend for me to contact and check their interest in co-applying for the grant that would be great (it's a short 3 page application)—if not, let's pass at this time. I did find some additional university colleagues at Northwestern that may be able to help us with mapping and interns for evaluation. I'll keep you posted on what I find. This week I'll call Joan Wynn and others for help with interns.

Talk to you soon -- I'll email you as soon as the web site is up.
Have a good Monday, Steve

----- Original Message -----



TO: Paul Collins

FROM: Dan Bassill

LOC: _____

FROM: Cabrini Connections—Tutor/Mentor Connection

PH: _____

PH: 312-573-8851

FAX: 773-463-1830

FAX: 312-573-8816

Pages 3 Including Cover Sheet

MESSAGE:

Paul,

This will be the first time we get to announce that you will be at the conference and what you will be doing.

I suggest you write two paragraphs describing two activities:

- 1) describe the survey process and invite people to register on Thursday and in the first session Friday to take the survey, with you to help them understand the purpose and power of group systems
- 2) describe a facilitation which you will lead (possibly with Steve Roussos) to help people begin to understand the findings of the survey. What does this data mean. This should be as much a demonstration of GroupSystems as a meeting of leaders.

I will schedule you a room on Thursday and Friday for this purpose. Then you and I and Steve will build a short list of people (fundors/partners) and work separate of the invitation process to get these people to come to one or both Friday afternoon sessions to see GroupSystems demonstrated and to be "sold" on providing funding to help us. This will be a critically important demonstration for each of us.

Please fill out this form. You will need to duplicate it to give the two different descriptions. I need this back by mid next week or earlier.

Thanks.

Dan

P.S. Due to Jimmy's DEATH I
will NOT have time to
Be at the MFN Conference.
Good Luck!
Dan

Subject: Re: Fw: Steve's evaluation update

Date: Wed, 16 Aug 2000 20:38:43 -0700

From: "STERGIOS TSAI ROUSSOS" <TSAI ROUSSOS@mindspring.com>

To: "Dan home" <tutormentor1@earthlink.net>, <tutormentor2@earthlink.net>

References: 1, 2

Hi Dan,

I like tutormentorR&D.net. But we cannot use the "&" character in a domain name.

What do you think of:
tutormentor-RD.net
or
tutormentor-RandD.net

I'll put it on my card and include it with a monthly or maybe quarterly statement to you.

Matt said the tutormentorexchange name was not purchased. He also gave me an excellent recommendation for a top-notch yet cheap web server provider, Burlee (that he uses too). It may come out to less than \$20 per month (unbelievable!).

I also asked Matt to what extent the company he works for (Leapnet) could provide us the services we need for a fee. After browsing his company's website I realized they have some pretty heavy-hitting companies as clients and could do all we want and more in a pinch. Matt said this is not likely since Leapnet is quite busy now and usually does not look at clients without a high profile and \$1,000,000+ projects. He did offer to give me a quote for the services we want (that is, what it would take if we would do web-based evaluation and GIS type services on a large scale) -- I'd like to use that figure to look for more grant money and supporters.

2 things I need from you:

1. Which of the names listed above you prefer, or offer a new one.
2. (not urgent) Send me an email attachment with last year's Excel sheets with student and volunteer attendance (the one with names on the left-hand column and the dates going across columns at the top).

If I can get connected with our new site by Friday, I'll put up a draft web data base up by Monday.

Thanks for the exciting work,
Steve

----- Original Message -----

From: "Daniel Bassill" <tutormentor2@earthlink.net>

To: "STERGIOS TSAI ROUSSOS" <tsai_roussos@mindspring.com>

Sent: Wednesday, August 16, 2000 4:18 PM

Subject: Re: Fw: Steve's evaluation update

> Steve,

>

> The ESRI info is exciting news. I like tutormentorR&D.net. It's shorter, R&D

> stands for research and development in business circles (who we are targeting)

> and it gets the words tutor/mentor into the name. The Acronym would take forever for people to find using search engines.

>

> While I can put this on the Cabrini Connections card it might be better to put

> it on your card and include in your monthly/quarterly expense statement.

Easier

> to track. I'm open either way.

>

> Dan

>

> STERGIOS TSAI ROUSSOS wrote:

>

Subject: Steve's evaluation update**Date:** Tue, 15 Aug 2000 18:01:30 -0700**From:** "STERGIOS TSAI ROUSSOS" <TSAI.ROUSSOS@mindspring.com>**To:** "Daniel F. Bassill" <tutormentor1@earthlink.net>**References:** 1, 2

Hi Dan,

Thanks for your comments on the tracking system. I can understand how stressed the group is right now. And Jimmy's death is a tremendous sadness. My plan is to keep out of the groups way as much as possible and stick to our timeline and deadlines we set. Once something is on the web we'll have plenty to get excited about. I did not place the following update on the egroups since it is more administrative in nature, but if you like I can post it there too.

I believe I can address most of the points and needs you and Beth mention and add some additional perks. I say most, since many of the tricks will be available to you on the web, but if you need something special done (such as a unique analysis for a funder) the data will be available in such a way that I can run more sophisticated analyses based on new categories, but not on the web (for now). Running reports by different dates to please different audiences will not be a problem since the "date" is a continuous variable and we can search and select whatever period of dates we want to report by. Some the questions I asked about how you define a year, etc. will help me set up automatic reports to search for the dates you currently use to define those periods.

This brings me to my next set of questions and an update. This past week I've researched many providers of web servers and the tools for doing what we want to do. Filemaker has many perks (such as being more user-friendly for most tasks), but ACCESS and Microsofts' suite of tools offer equal perks and more flexibility to do what we want without going to other vendors and buying additional software. For example, the ability to automatically chart any of the analyses we wish would cost an additional \$600 from an outside vendor to do this with Filemaker and even then the ability to do this on the web is not well developed. With ACCESS we can do it for no additional cost and it is web-ready. I purchased the developers edition of Microsoft with Frontpage and ACCESS (for \$120 compared to the market price of \$800; I got a deal on eBay). The software at the church and your T/MC PCs will be fine and I may add some new stuff to both, but that will be free too. For your Mac, as long as you use Internet Explorer 5.0 you should be fine. I am being sensitive to the money issue because whatever money we can save now we can use for any unpredicted "surprises" in needs and software later.

Besides software to do the work, I evaluated several dozen different web server providers. This provider will host our database and separate web page. The servers you have now are probably adequate, but what is missing is the customer support that I will need to access them reliably and troubleshoot as I develop our project. I learned that a web server needs to be set up in such a way as to support the software we use. For example if we were to use Filemaker the server would have to have software installed to support Filemaker. This is another advantage to sticking with Microsoft since most web server providers already support Microsoft products like ACCESS. The other thing we need is a web server provider that allows web databases. I found out that web databases are a sophisticated tool and a server needs to be set up correctly to be able to work with web databases that require online data manipulation. I found several good companies (meaning that they've been rated as top 10 web server providers) that can do all of this and provide 24-hour support to help us troubleshoot and develop our web project. The cost ranges from \$30 to \$50/month with about a \$50 set up fee and a \$70 fee to set up a new web domain or name. If you want we can use the domain you mentioned (tutormentorexchange) and set up the database there (as long as that domain name is up to date on its annual registration fee). Please tell me how you would like to set this up and pay for it (credit card would be best).

Once we have this set up (will take less than 2 days) I'm ready to put up a draft database for counting participation and the T/MC evaluation (recruitment campaign, Kansas system). I tried doing this with a free website I set up, but the server for it was not set up to handle these interactive databases. What would be great is if you could send me some Excel sheets with existing volunteer and student data (maybe last years). I am looking for the Excel sheets that have the volunteer and student names on them with the dates going across columns. I can place these on the web with the new system and hopefully make it easier for Beth to start using our web system this September. Please send these Excel sheets as email attachments.

Please tell me if anything I mentioned here does not make sense. Off I go to respond to some of the email on GIS. It looks like a talented group to work with.

Thanks,
Steve

PS Dan, sorry about the mix up in signing you for the web-eval egrouop. The address I used to sign you up was not correct. You are now correctly signed up.

----- Original Message -----

From: "Daniel F. Bassill" <tutormentor1@earthlink.net>

To: "STERGIOS TSAI ROUSSOS" <tsai_roussos@mindspring.com>

Sent: Monday, August 14, 2000 8:14 PM

Subject: Evaluation update

> Hi Steve,

>

> I sent back comments on the tracking system after Beth had made her
> comments. I hope that you'll be able to work with that information, and
> will email me separately for further Kids' Connection questions.

>

> With Jimmy's death last week, and the summer transition from Gena to
> Jackie in the lead, the group is extremely stressed. With school

mailto:Macintosh%20HD/System%20Folder/Preferences/NetScape%20Users/Daniel%20F.%20Bassill/Mail/Inbox?id=001301c0071d%2484f700c0%24155379a5940oemcomputer&number=11283849

Subject: [cc_staff] CC Learning & Management Center - sorry a bit long
Date: Thu, 29 Jun 2000 17:46:57 -0700
From: "STERGIOS TSAIROUSSOS" <tsai_roussos@mindspring.com>
Reply-To: cc_staff@egroups.com
To: <cc_staff@egroups.com>

Dear Cabrini Connection team, (Welcome Aimee!)

Thanks to each of you for your thoughtful responses to my questions about evaluation and our project to develop a web-based evaluation system. (If you have not responded to my 3 questions on evaluation, please do so as your time permits -- I'd love your input. The questions are also stated further in this email.)

Before I offer some responses and areas for us to start working together, let me say that I'm quite impressed by the diversity of talent and expertise that you all represent (and I know I have not heard from everyone). While I am impressed, I am not surprised, because ever since I came to know of Cabrini Connections a few years ago I realized that it was one of the most unique and committed organizations I have seen in the community of volunteer-based youth organizations. I hope you don't take for granted how good and powerful you are and how much you already have accomplished. I feel privileged to have this chance to work with you, and, honestly, I am not sure that this project we'll be working on can be accomplished by too many other groups in this arena at this time.

One of the things I find difficult, is communicating with meaning and clarity over the email -- it's tough for me to read long email with lots of information and make sense of it all. It is hard to read lots of information on one email and respond to it. But the success and, in some ways, one of the points of this project is to be able to communicate and do work from anywhere and at anytime (hence an Internet-based evaluation system)...so I will try to learn to do this better and please feel free to give me ideas on how to do this better. What I'll do here (if it works) is italicize any areas that I need your feedback so that it is easier to notice.

First, let me try to explain our project a bit more -- the creation of a Web-based Evaluation System. The project has an overall purpose but will be shaped specifically by our discussion. I placed a draft of the work plan used to get the grant for this project on our cc_staff egroups page. To see it, please go to our cc_staff page on egroups and find and click the area that says "files" and there you'll see a file called "eval workplan.doc" -- you can open up by clicking on it. *Please contact me if you have problems seeing this.*

The main broad purpose is to improve the way Cabrini Connections (CC) can track, understand, and improve what it does. This includes, for now, Kids' Connection (KC) and the T/MC -- but other components may be added if we see fit.

CC, KC, and T/MC has been doing this (tracking information, measurement, etc) for some time now and with some success. What will be different in our work are at least these 3 things:

1. The tools and methods will be available on the web through the T/MC web site.

People will be able to enter, search for, edit, graph, etc. tons of data and information from any time as long as they can get on the web. (Of course, we'll have back up systems on regular computers and even paper forms if we ever need them).

2. The system will incorporate the latest (dare I say best) ways to track, understand, and improve our work and its results.

This means current KC and T/MC information/data will be connected and new kinds of information will be tracked to help demonstrate what we do and its value (for youth and other stakeholder).

3. This will be a "learning" system - it will be able to change based on what we need and learn & it will be used to help teach others how to replicate what works and maybe do it better.

Some may call this a management information system or MIS, some call it evaluation and research, performance monitoring, and may other terms probably exist. In the title of this email I called it "CC Learning & Management Center" -- we can figure out a name as we go along.

What would you like to call it?

2 things are described in the rest of this email. First, a brief summary of what I heard in your emails and second, some next steps.

1. What does evaluation mean to you?

I like a comment Jackie made: "I just feel that knowing what we are looking at and why would influence my definition of what "evaluation" means to me." This is great and right on target ... your responses this question were related to what area of Cabrini Connection you are most involved with. Generally, people said evaluation was about finding out what works or if something is making a difference.

For me, evaluation is means asking and answering questions. We do this every day. The trick for program and organizational evaluation is learning how to ask the "right" questions (questions that matter) and ways to provide meaningful and useful answers.

2. What is your prior experience with program evaluation and/or information systems?

Looks like the team has a variety of experiences, including evaluation in the education and business arenas. I hope working on this project will offer new experiences for ways that you wish to grow.

3. What are two or three most important things about the T/MC and/or the Kids' Connection that you want to evaluate (that is, to understand or to find how to make better)?

Here are some general categories of what I heard. There were some great specific examples of things to measure.

Volunteer recruitment -- we want information that will help us attract, find, track, build, sustain, and expand/grow relationships with new volunteers and organizations/places that volunteers come from; we want information that tells us what of all we do works and to find new ways to accomplish these ends.

Program implementation -- we want information on how are students and volunteers participate and use our services and the results of this; we want this data to be easier to collect, accurate, and to make sense.

Outcomes - we want information that accurately shows the complete range of results and progress we contribute to for youth, volunteer, the groups we work with, and the community. This includes results for a single activity or from several events together, academic and specific results as well as less tangible social results, short term and long term results.

Subject: [cc_staff] New member introduction
Date: Mon, 26 Jun 2000 22:14:17 -0000
From: tsai_roussos@mindspring.com
Reply-To: cc_staff@egroups.com
To: cc_staff@egroups.com

Hi Everyone,

My name is Stergios Tsai Roussos, but I go by Steve. I am a researcher and evaluator for public health and community youth development initiatives. I have worked with the T/MC for the past couple of years by doing evaluation workshops at the conferences and helping write grants. Now, thanks to a grant we received from the Fry Foundation, I'll be working more closely with Cabrini Connections to set up an Internet-based evaluation/information system for the T/MC and the Kids' Connection.

I have met some of you on my trips to Chicago (now I'm in Allentown, Pennsylvania) and I look forward to meeting the rest of you soon.

To develop this evaluation/information system (I'll call it EIS for now) I will need your valuable input (by email and in person) on what information is important to track and what will be the best way to tack it. The overall purpose of the EIS project is to create a way for all programs of Cabrini Connections to understand and improve how they serve the Chicago community. My job is help create the EIS in a manner that is most useful and helpful to you. Based on our work together, the EIS will eventually be available to other tutor/mentor organizations that want to evaluate their efforts. This will help programs and organizations like us to improve their ability to get human and financial support for what they do.

I'll be coming out for a visit in July and will email the specific dates as soon as I know them. I'll be using the egroups to update everyone on the development of the EIS.

Before my visit, I would love some information from you that will help me with the EIS. Would you please respond to these questions using this egroups?

1. What does evaluation mean to you?
2. What is your prior experience with program evaluation and/or information systems?
3. What are two or three most important things about the T/MC and/or the Kids' Connection that you want to evaluate (that is, to understand or to find how to make better)?

Please feel free to email or call me with any questions.
610-402-2571 or 610-867-4783

Thanks for your help,
Steve

ps If you know of someone at Cabrini Connections that would like to know about the EIS and is not on this list or not comfortable using email, please print this email and share it with them.

To Post a message, send it to: cc_staff@eGroups.com

To Unsubscribe, send a blank message to: cc_staff-unsubscribe@eGroups.com

Subject: Re: Tutor/Mentor and eval**Date:** Mon, 12 Jun 2000 23:40:38 -0700**From:** "STERGIOS TSAI ROUSSOS" <TSAI ROUSSOS@mindspring.com>**To:** <tutormentor2@earthlink.net>**References:** 1

Hi Dan,

Hope all is well. I had a good time at the conference in Boston. Geomapping was all over the place. I found one researcher at Johns Hopkins that is doing some work on the effects of intergenerational volunteerism. He and his group just received a large grant to study what happens when older adults volunteer with youth in schools. Definitely will follow up with him. I also learned that mapping software can be highly inaccurate (ArcView maps addresses correctly but geocodes -- puts an address in the correct place -- with 49% accuracy). I also made some other connections with folks that may help us with our mapping work and funding. I think we should add mapping into the evaluation system work plan more explicitly. Please tell me what you think.

I've attached a cleaner version of our work plan and a contract. Please take a look and revise as needed. I'm looking forward to getting this started. My colleagues from work and I met again to see how we might work together about setting up an evaluation shop for not-for-profits. One of our folks has a friend at the Pew Charitable Trusts in Philadelphia and we'll be meeting with him to pick his brain about the potential for our idea and support from them. I looked at their page and T/MC work is within their funding scheme (<http://www.pewtrusts.com/>). The goal is to start something formal by this December, but folks are not willing to leave their day jobs until steady work comes in. For me, I'm ready to leave my day job as soon as I have a year's worth of funding (enough to look for the year after). As you'll see on the contract, I decided to set up my own shop until then (Community Research Centers) and begin looking for funding (with your help).

Matt answered many of my questions about putting our system on the T/MC page and so far it looks like that will be a good way to go (rather than setting up a separate server).

I'll take a look at the site below. Who knows maybe we can turn our plan for our evaluation system into an article and a proposal for additional funding from Pew.

Talk to you soon,
Steve

----- Original Message -----

From: <tutormentor2@earthlink.net>

To: <tsai_roussos@mindspring.com>; <stergios.Roussos@lvh.com>

Sent: Monday, June 12, 2000 11:58 AM

Subject: Tutor/Mentor

> Steve,
>
> Hope your conference went well. I'll look for an update. Here's
> something you may be interested in writing an article for.
>
> Dan
>
> Subj:
>
> Call for Articles
> Date:
>
> Mon, 12 Jun 2000 9:09:39 AM Eastern Daylight Time
> From:
>
> "Kate Conley" <kconley@iste.org>
> To:
>
> EDTECH@h-net.msu.edu, digitaldivide@list.benton.org, "Curriculum
> Integration
> & Technology Discussion Forum"

> <techintegration@listserv.eschoolnews.com>
>
> Learning & Leading with Technology
> Theme Issues for 2000-2001
>
> We are planning two theme issues for Volume 28 of Learning & Leading
> with
> Technology (a publication of the International Society for Technology
> in
> Education). We invite you to submit articles on these themes. We are
> also
> looking for good curriculum articles incorporating math, science,
> language
> arts, social studies, music, or art. The Submission Guidelines are
> posted on
> the web at www.iste.org/L&L. If you have any further questions, please
> contact:
>
> Anita Best
> Acquisitions Editor, L&L
> ISTE
> 1787 Agate St.
> Eugene, OR 97403-1923
> ph. 541.346.2400
> fax 541.346.5890
> abest@iste.org
>
> Volume 28 Theme Issues
>
> February 2001 Closing the Digital Divide
> The Digital Divide is often described as a gap in access to technology
> and
> information between groups by any of the following: income, race,
> gender,
> location, or education. Articles in this issue cover the efforts and
> partnerships needed to continue to bring access to all students. We
> also
> know that access is not the whole problem in bringing the potential of
> technology to education. Articles may also address staff development
> and
> curriculum needed to make use of the technology to provide all students
> with
> learning opportunities to meet their full potential.
>
> Submission deadline: August 16, 2000
>
> April 2001 Student-Centered Use of Highly Interactive Computer
> Software
> Many powerful software applications now exist from spreadsheets to
> software
> such as GIS, NIHls Image, Microcomputer-Based Lab (MBL), and
> Mathematica.
> Some organizations such as the University of Michigan's Center for
> Highly
> Interactive Computing in Education (hi-ce) are developing powerful
> tools for
> specific curriculum areas
> (www.investigationstation.org/hiceoffice/index.html). Other educational
>
> software packages have research-based models shaping their development.
> All
> these programs can allow students to explore difficult concepts,
> overcome
> physical or mental handicaps, or make sense of large amounts of data as
>
> opposed to tools used to present and communicate results. Articles in
> this
> issue describe the tools, projects, curricula, and outcomes of using
> such
> software.
>
> Submission deadline: November 6, 2000
>
>
>
> ***

Subject: Intern position**Date:** Thu, 22 Jun 2000 23:32:44 -0700**From:** "STERGIOS TSAI ROUSSOS" <TSAL ROUSSOS@mindspring.com>**To:** <tutormentor2@earthlink.net>, "Dan home" <tutormentor1@earthlink.net>

Hi Dan,

Please review and revise this description for the intern position (if possible and depending on the quality of the interns and school's ability to fund them we could use more than 2).

June 22, 2000

Intern Positions Available**Title:** Research and Information System Assistant (RISA)**Positions available:** 2**Date needed:** Immediately**Duration of position:** One year preferred.**Hours per week:** 10 to 20 (some weeks less)**Who may apply:** Anyone with the experience and competencies described below.

(Open to all undergraduate and graduate majors).

Organization: Tutor/Mentor Connection of Chicago**Work location:** Primarily at the Tutor/Mentor Connection and through the Internet.

Some local travel may be required.

Work description: RISAs will help develop and implement an Internet-based information system. The system will be used by organizations that provide services and infrastructure support for tutor/mentor programs anywhere in the world. Also, the system will be used to conduct applied research studies to understand and improve (1) the effectiveness of tutor/mentor programs and organizations and (2) the capacity of business, civic, and other community sectors to support successful youth development. Activities include the development of Internet and off-line information system tools and procedures, data collection, entry, and analysis, and preparation of reports and presentations. The work requires interaction with people of all ages and from all community sectors. Some training will be provided. Opportunities and support are available for independent research.

Necessary experience and competencies: Ability to work well with others, leadership, curiosity, creativity, excellent reading, writing, and typing ability, word processing, and Internet and email use. Experience with data management and applied research is a plus.

Pay: \$\$\$\$

Subject: Re: [cc_staff] New member introduction
Date: Tue, 27 Jun 2000 13:13:31 -0700 (PDT)
From: La Tapatia <jackie21CabriniC@yahoo.com>
Reply-To: cc_staff@egroups.com
To: cc_staff@egroups.com

Dear Steve,

My name is Jacqueline Rubert (Jackie). This is my third year working as an educational resource person for Cabrini Connections' Kids Connection. I am looking forward to meeting you and working with you. I believe that the development of an evaluation/information system will be of great value to all of us. I appreciate that you have asked for our input on the three questions you put forth, but I find them incredibly difficult to answer simply. I think the reason for this is that I distinguish between the type of information that I find useful as an educator/program co-ordinator, and the type of information that it is important for Cabrini Connections to provide to "show/prove it works". I am not saying that there are not mutually useful meeting points, I just feel that knowing what we are looking at and why would influence my definition of what "evaluation" means to me.

My prior experience with program evaluation has been to administer tests to children and adults. There were different tests for different age groups and most of the tests focused on things such as print awareness, literacy development and language proficiency of second language learners. I also gave various interviews and questionnaires as part of this same program, and wrote periodic observational reports. With a different program, I have been asked to evaluate curriculum, teacher performance and student performance as a team member of an educational support group for a public school that was on probation. Our job was to identify what was causing the school to fail and to make recommendations and give support to help the school become more effective/successful.

I am not sure how to answer your question about information systems. Obviously, we work closely with the T/MC. I have had a variety of jobs outside my field and have almost ten years working in the field of education. I might have relevant experience with regard to information systems but I just don't understand the term in this context. Sorry.

As far as two or three things I would like to evaluate or understand how to do better, I would definitely like to understand how to motivate volunteers to get involved beyond the one-on-one tutoring. We need volunteers to help with our various committees and programs. I would like to know what are the most important factors in keeping both volunteers and students enthusiastic and involved in our program. I would like to figure out a way to highlight and/or help people understand and value positive outcomes of our program that may be non-academic (in the sense that they are not related to grades/school performance.)

I know I can probably do a better job of answering these questions when I know more about what we are going to focus on and what kind of assessment we will use. I am sorry if my response is confusing and not very helpful. I look forward to learning more about this project so that I can give more to-the-point input. I appreciate being asked anyway.

Please feel free to email on this egroupp, or at jackie21cabrinic@yahoo.com or to call me at (312) 943-5701.

Thanks, Jackie

tsai_roussos@mindspring.com wrote:

Hi Everyone,

My name is Stergios Tsai Roussos, but I go by Steve. I am a researcher and evaluator for public health and community youth development initiatives. I have worked with the T/MC for the past couple of years by doing evaluation workshops at the conferences and helping write grants. Now, thanks to a grant we received from the Fry Foundation, I'll be working more closely with Cabrini Connections to set up an Internet-based evaluation/information system for the T/MC and the Kids' Connection.

I have met some of you on my trips to Chicago (now I'm in Allentown, Pennsylvania) and I look forward to meeting the rest of you soon.

To develop this evaluation/information system (I'll call it EIS for now) I will need your valuable input (by email and in person) on what information is important to track and what will be the best way to track it. The overall purpose of the EIS project is to create a way for all programs of Cabrini Connections to understand and improve how they serve the Chicago community. My job is help create the EIS in a manner that is most useful and helpful to you. Based on our work together, the EIS will eventually be available to other tutor/mentor organizations that want to evaluate their efforts. This will help programs and organizations like us to improve their ability to get human and financial support for what they do.

I'll be coming out for a visit in July and will email the specific dates as soon as I know them. I'll be using the egroupp to update everyone on the development of the EIS.

mailbox:/Cabrini%20Marketing/System%20Folder/Preferences/Netscape%20Users/
Dan%20Bassill/Mail/Inbox?id=20000627201331.14171.qmail%40web3906.mail.yahoo.com&

Before my visit, I would love some information from you that will help me with the EIS. Would you please respond to these questions using this egroups?

1. What does evaluation mean to you?
2. What is your prior experience with program evaluation and/or information systems?
3. What are two or three most important things about the T/MC and/or the Kids' Connection that you want to evaluate (that is, to understand or to find how to make better)?

Please feel free to email or call me with any questions.
610-402-2571 or 610-867-4783

Thanks for your help,
Steve

ps If you know of someone at Cabrini Connections that would like to know about the EIS and is not on this list or not comfortable using email, please print this email and share it with them.

To Post a message, send it to: cc_staff@eGroups.com

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Wednesday, June 28, 2000

Re: [cc_staff] New member introduction

Subject: Re: [cc_staff] New member introduction

Date: Tue, 27 Jun 2000 18:53:53 EDT

From: reidschultz@cs.com

Reply-To: cc_staff@egroups.com

To: cc_staff@egroups.com

Hi Steve (and everyone else),

I am Reid Schultz. I work for the T/MC as a volunteer recruiter and am in charge of our annual Volunteer Recruitment Campaign.

I am most interested in tracking calls and requests from interested individuals who contact us regarding becoming volunteers either at our organization or at one of the hundreds that we refer them to. How did they hear about us and how can we best help them in their volunteering goals. Much of what I am interested in in terms of evaluation has to do with our many outreach efforts and seeing how they reach people and then cause them to contact us. I would also be interested in seeing how many of them become volunteers, but that is usually left up to the efforts of volunteer coordinators and program directors. Overall, I have little prior experience in this.

I am looking forward to finding out what services you will be providing and how I can participate in them. I can be reached at 773-871-5344 or at reidschultz@cs.com.

Thanks, Reid.

Was the salesman clueless? Productopia has the answers.
http://click.egroups.com/1/4633/10/_/407566/_/962146470/

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Subject: Re: [cc_staff] New member introduction
Date: Wed, 28 Jun 2000 12:19:23 CDT
From: "Beth Galantha" <bgalantha@hotmail.com>
Reply-To: cc_staff@egroups.com
To: cc_staff@egroups.com

Steve:

Hello! It's nice that you are still helping us out with our efforts! It's refreshing to hear you are working on this evaluation project - it would be wonderful to be able to evaluate what we do to reflect our program more accurately.

I see evaluation as the tool to show the different components of what we do to help us see where and what we need to improve and what is working and why. Once the proper evaluation is in place, it is available to share with other programs so that they may evaluate their own programs to note their shortcomings, successes, and overall progress. Evaluation, to me, seems to be the most important step after implementing a program, because without it, how do you know if you are helping people and the community you mean to serve?

I do not believe i have much experience with evaluation, other than in educational settings (e.g. evaluating one's progress, evaluating a class or workshop, etc.) I do try to evaluate the attendance at Cabrini Connections Kids Connection, which is done through weekly data entry and quarterly and yearly charts and graphs.

The three most important things about the Kids' Connection and Tutor/Mentor connection that i want to see evaluated are:

Kids Connection:

1. How do we find ways to use the attendance data we collect to understand cabrini connections? For example, how can we use this data to keep attendance and retention of students and volunteers high and to note patterns in drop out? What can we tell the staff, etc. the numbers actually mean in order to keep morale and momentum up, rather than leaving them confused or that the data does not reflect the the program's actual success. I'd like conclusions based on this data to be accurate.

2. Is our current method of tracking attendance the most effective out there and does it reflect the needs of our program, or are we actually hurting our numbers by being inaccurate by using this system (it is not very user friendly and it leaves a lot of room for human error). What are our other alternatives and the advantages/disadvantages of these alternatives? Ideally, i think Dan and I would like to see students getting more involved in their attendance (e.g. having a student worker do the attendance data entry) but the system now is difficult to explain and as i mentioned, leaves a lot of room for human errors (having to create and recreate formulas, percentages, etc.) Is there a way to track, evaluate and distinguish volunteers who serve different purposes here? committee volunteers, volunteers who come weekly or bi-monthly but who do not do one-on-one tutoring, and those who are one-on one-tutors all contribute ato our program, but currently, we don't distinguish between them and the way they all affect our numbers differently.

3. Is there a way to track and evaluate student/volunteer retention that is easy to use and understand? The current method is not very easy to use (sorry, Dan)and is a bit confusing. Currently, our attendance data entry and retention information is all in Excel - is this the best program for what we are trying to track and evaluate?

These are the aspects of the Kids Connection Program that i feel deserve proper evaluation. Without evaluating our attendance and retention numbers, again, how do we know if we are meeting the needs of our volunteers and students? And how can we explain patterns if we know they exist but can't track them to reflect the accuracy and personality of our situation/program or if these patterns are "fixable".

Thank you, Steve. I look forward to discussing this with you in person. I will be on vacation from July 14 - July 19, just so you are aware of this. If you will be visiting during the time that i am gone, i would still like to communicate the progress through e-mail. Have a wonderful summer!

Subject: [cc_staff] New member introduction
Date: Wed, 28 Jun 2000 11:59:48 -0700 (PDT)
From: Sheridan Enomoto <turtleconnection_2000@yahoo.com>
Reply-To: cc_staff@egroups.com
To: cc_staff@egroups.com

Hello Stergios!

My name is Sheridan Enomoto and I am an Americorps VISTA working at Cabrini Connection Kids' Connection. I am creating a position for a volunteer administrator. My focus is in retaining and recruiting volunteers, specifically for the Kids' Connection. I am interested in learning more about any evaluative method that helps track and maintain volunteers. The only experience I have had in evaluation is creating feedback surveys for our volunteers and students. These surveys have been helpful in providing suggestions for the improvement of our program but more can be done in this area. Jackie Rubert also mentioned volunteer involvement other than one-on-one tutoring. How can we get volunteers involved in our other programs? I am personally aware of volunteer services that will post volunteer positions on the internet or refer interested volunteers to different programs. (e.g. Chicago Serves) Do you have any other suggestions? I am also aware of outcome measurement and how you can measure the outcomes of your organization or program. I would like to learn more about the different types of outcome measurements.

I look forward to meeting you and I hope I will learn a lot from you! My e-mail address is turtleconnection_2000@yahoo.com. Take care and have a wonderful summer!
Sheridan

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Subject: Re: T/MC Evaluation**Date:** Wed, 14 Jun 2000 22:23:59 -0700**From:** "STERGIOS TSAI ROUSSOS" <TSAI ROUSSOS@mindspring.com>**To:** <tutormentor2@earthlink.net>**References:** 1

Hi Dan,
How did it go with the Chicago Community Trust?

I've attached the revised contract and plan. I made the adjustments for a \$10,000 fee and language for invoice procedures for the other expenditures. Invoicing adds a bit more of a paper trail but will be fine with me. Please take a look and tell me what you think.

Two other things -- When should we plan our first meeting for this? and Would it be ok if I start looking for an intern from a Chicago college to help us out? (we would both interview any potential candidates) I'm thinking, if possible, it would be great to have interns and other help with us from the start rather than waiting for the start of the retrospective evaluation work. Ideally this would be a "free" (that is the college would support them) or "volunteer" position, but do you think it would be possible for T/MC to offer some reimbursement?

Steve

----- Original Message -----

From: <tutormentor2@earthlink.net>

To: <tsai_roussos@mindspring.com>; <stergios.Roussos@lvh.com>

Sent: Wednesday, June 14, 2000 8:20 AM

Subject: T/MC Evaluation

> Steve,
>
> I've reviewed the work plan and it looks fine. I've also reviewed the
> contract and have one area we need to discuss.
>
> You've rolled the purchase of Information System (software, database,
> forms, etc. and travel) into the compensation. I'd like to keep these
> separate and invoice them as we spend them. That would mean we'd pay
> you \$10,000 in four quarterly installments and spend the rest on the
> project as needed. If we don't need to spend the money on software we'll
> spend it elsewhere to make the project work, even on more of your time,
> as needed.
>
> Let's discuss this if you feel differently. Wish me luck. I'm meeting
> with someone from the Chicago Community Trust in a few minutes.
>
> Dan
>
>
>



[tmc eval workplan2 word 6.doc](#)

Name: tmc eval workplan2 word 6.doc
Type: Microsoft Word Document (application/msword)
Encoding: base64



[tmcevalcontract2 word 6.doc](#)

Name: tmcevalcontract2 word 6.doc
Type: Microsoft Word Document (application/msword)
Encoding: base64

Subject: Re: Dan Bassil, re: tutormentorexchange.net
 Date: Thu, 13 Sep 2001 12:41:38 -0700
 From: "Stergios Roussos" <steve@akouo.org>
 Organization: akouo
 To: "kmccann" <kmccann@ksu.edu>
 CC: "Daniel Bassil" <tutormentor2@earthlink.net>
 References: 1

Dear Kevin,

Dan forwarded your comments in hope of us starting a conversation for some joint work, and ideally joint funding between the Tutor/Mentor Connection and your group. I am a public health researcher out of California and have been working with Dan on various projects since 1998. The Tutor/Mentor Exchange is one of our current projects.

Interestingly, I also used to work with David Dziewaltowski at the Kinesiology Dept. on a project called Kansas LEAN. Please extend my hello's to him if you are in touch with him. That work came out of my time as a graduate student at KU for the evaluation of a community-based CVD prevention initiative. I worked with the KU Work Group for Community Health and Development and in the last steps of my doctoral work there.

Anyway, your comments and analysis below are right on the mark. As a university-based researcher working with community organizations in my earlier life I understand the struggle to balance university priorities and "way of doing business" with what community organizations really need. Universities, and unfortunately, many foundations, are usually looking to help and be part of the "newest, big thing" rather than help with the ongoing, daily work. The Loka Institute is a wonderful resources that I have not tapped into enough.

As one of T/MC's research partners I would be very eager to discuss some of the opportunities you mention below and others we have yet to think of. I do think your group could play a wonderful role in "knowledge" creation and management on the Tutor/Mentor Exchange (TME) website. This could include both web and off-line products. There are also some avenues for ongoing research and teaching that are fundable by university and foundation grants, and governmental sources. There is a great need for such work in the tutor/mentor community which links to every other social improvement effort.

Please feel free to contact me by phone or email, or tell me of some times that are good for you and I can call you.

Best wishes for peace during this sad time,
 Thanks,
 Steve

Stergios Roussos
 Akouo
 Public Health Scientist
 (209) 723.4398
 (530) 685.6715 (fax)
 www.akouo.org

----- Original Message -----

From: "kmccann" <kmccann@ksu.edu>
 To: <Cabrinic@aol.com>
 Sent: Wednesday, September 12, 2001 6:50 AM
 Subject: To: Dan Bassil, re: tutormentorexchange.net

> Hello Dan,
 > You wrote me a while back when I suggested to the afterschool listserv members
 > that a web site devoted to making sense of/sorting/adding to the Mott list
 > could be greatly beneficial to those who work in afterschool programs. At
 > that time you mentioned to me some of the web-based work your group was doing
 > and suggested that we consider ways to work together, given our similar
 > directions and use of the internet as a support and learning tool.
 >
 > Since the time we conversed via e-mail, the Mott Foundation has shown no
 > interest in developing the type of web site I described. I wish I could say I
 > am surprised, but unfortunately it fits what I've seen with many funding
 > agencies who like to fund the "big" ideas and events but then do not follow-up
 > with support for the more "routine", daily work that ultimately decides the
 > success or failure of the initiative. I'm not just picking on Mott, many
 > other funders including the feds and State-level folks do the same. It is
 > disappointing, however -- I'm a "ground-level" project person, focused mostly
 > on the needs of the actual practitioners, and clearly what I proposed is very
 > much needed.
 >
 > You had suggested that perhaps we could talk about what your group is doing
 > and how that work could be supported via a web based site/tools. I see from
 > your web site:
 > <http://www.tutormentorexchange.net/Index.htm>
 > that you all have made great progress, congratulations! I think adding some
 > of the features I recommended for a support website (such as white papers, moderated review/comments on queries, etc.) would add greatly to your work.
 >
 > Collaboration with a higher ed office/department might indeed be of benefit to

yours

- > need greatly is the abilities to take vast amounts of disparate information
- > and guide/restructure it into useable knowledge for practitioner's ready use.
- > There's many challenges, however, with working with higher ed groups on projects such as yours (maybe you've already run into some of these).
- Many
- > higher education groups have a distinct academic and institutional bias --
- > these groups have a difficult time being true "partners" on community-based
- > projects. The cost of collaborative arrangements with higher education
- > partners can be prohibitive. And the "products" the higher ed partner might
- > be pursuing could be very different from those your organization wishes to achieve.
- >
- > Best bet would be a partnership between your group and a local higher
- > education institution that has a focus on your geographic area and supports
- > true "community-based research". A place to look for information on such
- > groups is at: <http://www.foia.org/crn/index.htm>
- > there's a listserv there to which you might post a message.
- >
- > Can my work office partner with your organization on developing on-line
- > tools/knowledge for tutor-mentors? Only through a funded project or
- > subcontract, as (1) working with an out-of-state group would not be considered
- > to fall within the public service role of our state land grant
- institution,
- > and (2) all official project work here is required to have funding
- support.
- > Would you be pleased with the result of such a partnership? -- I'm unsure,
- I
- > fear that (similar nationally to many higher ed/community partnerships)
- from
- > an institutional perspective your project would be just another
- > contract/award, not something that the institution would strongly "believe
- in"
- > and support. Now, that's not to say that you cannot find individuals such
- as
- > myself who do have strong beliefs in grass-roots support projects, and who
- > would do an excellent job for you. The greatest challenge to
- > university-based, "community-based research" advocates such as myself,
- > however, is that we must work within academic and institutional cultures
- that
- > do not support (financially, timewise, professionally, etc.) true
- grass-roots
- > partnerships focused on the end-needs of the community partner. Your
- > organization may need to contract with people individually (rather than
- > through higher ed institutions) to get what you want.
- >
- > Good luck to you, I'll check the tutor-mentor website occasionally to see
- how
- > all is going.
- >
- > Kevin
- >
- > Kevin M. McCann
- > Office of Educational Innovation and Evaluation
- > Kansas State University
- > 2323 Anderson Avenue
- > Suite 220
- > Manhattan, KS 66502
- > kmccann@ksu.edu
- >
- >